

Stabilizing quantities ρ_p for boundary control of PDE

Amaury Hayat

February 09, 2026

Context

This is a question originally raised by Jean-Michel Coron in 2016. When studying the stability of nonlinear PDE of the form

$$\partial_t u + A(u) \partial_x u + B(u) = 0, \quad \text{on } [0, L], \quad (1)$$

where $u \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and with boundary conditions of the form

$$\begin{pmatrix} u_+(t, 0) \\ u_-(t, L) \end{pmatrix} = G \begin{pmatrix} u_+(t, L) \\ u_-(t, 0) \end{pmatrix}, \quad (2)$$

a natural quantity that appears is the following function

$$\rho_p : M \mapsto \inf \{ \|\Delta M \Delta^{-1}\|_p \mid \Delta = \text{diag}(\delta_1, \dots, \delta_n), \delta_i > 0, \forall i \in \{1, \dots, n\} \}, \quad (3)$$

where $\|\cdot\|_p$ is the matrix p -norm.

Conjectures

Conjecture 1. *For any $M \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ one has*

$$\rho_2(M) \leq \rho_3(M) \leq \dots \leq \rho_\infty(M).$$

A weaker version is:

Conjecture 2. *For any $M \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ one has*

$$\rho_2(M) \leq \rho_k(M), \quad \forall k \in \mathbb{N} \setminus \{0\}.$$

Conjecture 3. *For any $n > 6$ and any $p > 2$ ($n, p \in \mathbb{N}$), there exists $M \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ such that*

$$\rho_p(M) < \rho_{p+1}(M). \quad (4)$$

What is already known

The main previous works are in [2, 1]. In particular it is known that for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and any $M \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$,

$$\rho_1(M) \geq \rho_2(M), \quad \rho_1(M) = \rho_\infty(M),$$

and for $n \geq 2$ there exists $M \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ such that

$$\rho_1(M) > \rho_2(M).$$

It is also known [3] that if M has only non-negative coefficients then

$$\rho_k(M) = \rho_1(M), \quad \forall k \in [1, +\infty].$$

References

- [1] Jean-Michel Coron and Hoai-Minh Nguyen. Dissipative boundary conditions for nonlinear 1-D hyperbolic systems: sharp conditions through an approach via time-delay systems. *SIAM J. Math. Anal.*, 47(3):2220–2240, 2015.
- [2] Jean-Michel Coron, Georges Bastin, and Brigitte d’Andréa-Novel. Dissipative boundary conditions for one-dimensional nonlinear hyperbolic systems. *SIAM Journal on Control and Optimization*, 47(3):1460–1498, 2008.
- [3] Siegfried M. Rump. Optimal scaling for p -norms and componentwise distance to singularity. *IMA Journal of Numerical Analysis*, 23(1):1–9, 2003.